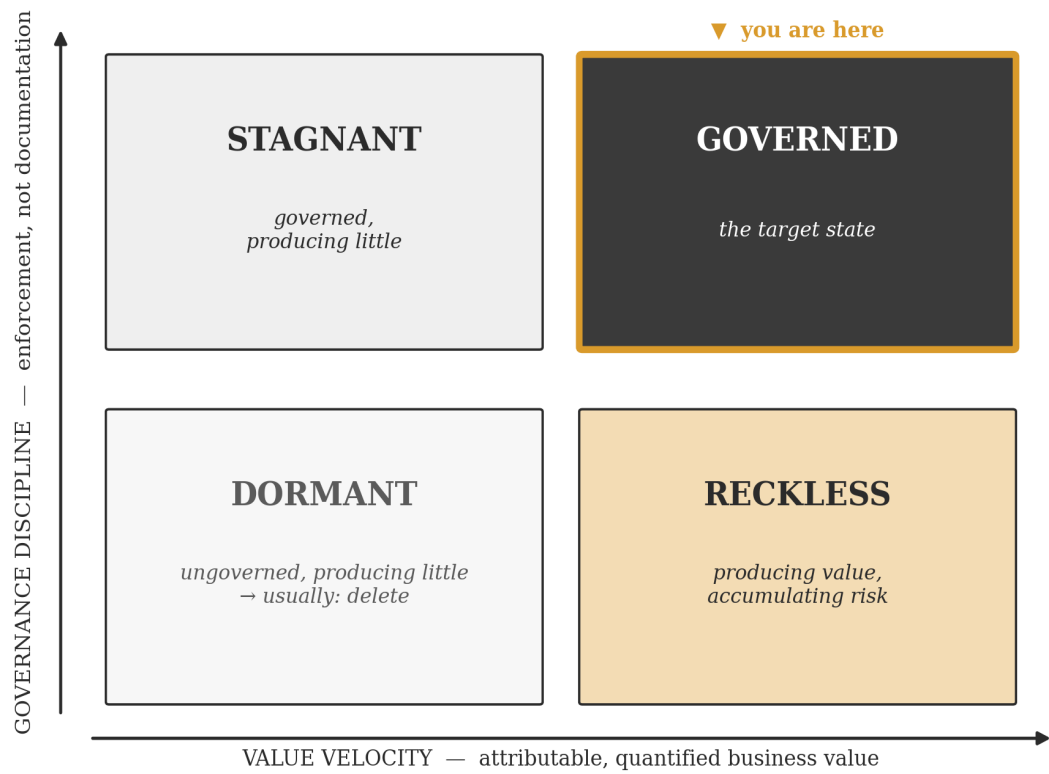


Your position: **GOVERNED**

the target state — with one honest caveat



What this position means

Measurable value inside a documented, enforced, monitored frame: owners named, boundaries technically enforced, monitoring continuous. When something drifts it is detected; when something fails it can be explained. The caveat, stated plainly: this result reflects your answers about the estate you know. If your visibility answers were weak, the systems you do not know about are not inside this dot — and the most common way for a genuinely well-governed core to coexist with an ungoverned periphery is to mistake the core for the whole.

Direction of travel: Governed → demonstrably Governed

The migration from position to proof. Two frontiers: verify the map covers the territory, and push discipline from “enforced” to “demonstrable from telemetry.”

The first three moves

- **1. Run the misdiagnosis check against yourself.** Commission a multi-signal discovery exercise — SSO/OAuth logs, expense data, repo scans — and reconcile it against the official register. The distance between the two is your real finding. If it is small, you have earned the position; if it is not, your Governed pocket is real but your organisation is Bureaucratic.
- **2. Push the top systems from discipline 3 to 4.** Level 4 means every governance claim is demonstrable from the system's own telemetry without manual reconstruction — the difference between passing an audit and defending a specific disputed decision in hours.
- **3. Convert governance into velocity.** The governed route should now be paying a reuse dividend: measure what share of governance components — access routes, logging patterns, review thresholds, evidence structures — the next deployment inherits rather than rebuilds. If reuse is low, you have governance without compounding.

The characteristic obstacle

Complacency wearing the register's clothes. The strongest signal of a true Governed position is the appetite to go looking for the systems that would disprove it.

Watch for: Vendor-embedded AI is the usual blind spot at this position: features activated inside platforms you already own enter the estate without passing your governed route. Extend discovery to cover them explicitly.

What to measure

- Estate visibility: discovered systems vs registered systems, reconciled quarterly.
- Runtime evidence coverage: share of material systems whose decision paths reconstruct from telemetry alone.
- Reuse rate on new deployments — the velocity dividend, made measurable.

Rescoring — the instrument itself

Your questionnaire result is a screening across the estate on average. The instrument proper is applied per system.

Governance Discipline (0–4):

0	No owner, no documentation, no monitoring. The system exists; nobody is accountable.
1	Owner named. No enforced controls, no monitoring baseline. Governance is a name on a list.
2	Policy exists and is <i>partially</i> enforced. Monitoring manual or intermittent. (A policy nobody can show is enforced scores 1, not 2.)
3	Policy enforced consistently. Active monitoring with a review cadence. Incident escalation documented <i>and tested</i> .
4	Every governance claim is demonstrable from the system's own telemetry. The system could face a regulator with evidence behind every claim.

Scores 0–1 plot Low; 3–4 High; a 2 is the transition zone — err low. **Value Velocity** is one question: can we attribute and quantify this system's KPI contribution, with a defensible number and methodology — yes or no?

The exercise, in five steps

Capture leadership's belief first and do not let anyone revise it. Build the real inventory from multiple signals — not from project registrations. Score every system with the rubric above, erring low where evidence is missing (missing evidence is the finding). Plot the map. Measure the distance between the belief and the data — that gap is the headline of the board report. Repeat quarterly: the Quadrant is a snapshot, and the direction of travel matters more than any single placement.

Status of this instrument

A working diagnostic from the field research behind *Govern or Fail: Why Enterprise AI Fails After the Demo* — deliberately published here rather than in the book, which stops where validation stops. The book is the diagnosis; this is the field kit. Use it, and where it breaks, tell me: governorfail.com. *Govern or Fail* launches September 2026.